PRACTITIONER PROTOCOL

Hair Color

Times in [brackets] follow your color line's instructions and never pass its maximum. Check your state board rules.

SCREEN

Intake cleared. Scalp free of sores, infection and sunburn. Full chemical history.

ALLERGY ALERT TEST

[48] hours before every color service, or per the maker. Record result; waiver if declined.

STRAND TEST

For correction or unknown history. Required if box dye, henna or metallic dye is possible.

SET UP FIRST ☐ Hands washed, gloves on ☐ Cape, towel, neck strip ☐ Bowls, brushes, clips ☐ Scale and timer ☐ Color in date, lots noted ☐ Barrier cream, eyewash, SDS

#	STEP	TIME	HOW
1	**Consult**	10–15 min	Assess level, tone, % gray, porosity and history. Agree goal and price.
2	**Consent & photos**	5 min	Consent signed, allergy test result checked. Before photos in good light.
3	**Prep & protect**	5 min	Drape, gloves on. Barrier cream on hairline and ears. Hair dry per label.
4	**Formulate**	5 min	Weigh color and developer: 10 vol to deposit, 20 vol for gray or lift.
5	**Roots & gray**	[ ] min	Regrowth first; resistant gray areas first. Pre-soften if needed.
6	**Mids & ends**	[ ] min	Pull through only if faded. Demi or gloss on lengths avoids banding.
7	**Process**	[ ] min	Timer per manufacturer. No heat unless label allows. Check comfort.
8	**Strand check**	2 min	Wipe a strand: coverage and even tone. Extend only to label max.
9	**Emulsify & rinse**	5 min	Massage with water, rinse until clear. Color-safe shampoo, conditioner.
10	**Finish & photos**	10+ min	Remove any skin stain, style, check the result. Take after photos.
11	**Aftercare & rebook**	5 min	Review aftercare: wait [48–72] hours to wash. Roots in [4–8] weeks.

ENDPOINT AND SAFETY

- Even coverage root to ends; no banding or hot roots
- 40 vol is off-scalp only; never on the scalp
- Gloves for all mixing, applying and rinsing
- Never use hair dye on lashes or brows

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

- Color in the eye: flush with cool running water or eyewash for 15 minutes, then seek medical care.
- Hives, swelling or wheezing: stop and rinse out. Call 911 if breathing is affected.
- Too dark or off-tone: don't re-process today. Plan a correction and book a follow-up.
- Burning or itching on the scalp: stop, rinse thoroughly with cool water, and assess before going on.
- Heat, smoke or odor while processing: likely metallic dye. Rinse at once; no more chemicals.
- Later blisters, oozing or swelling: refer to a physician. Report to the maker and FDA MedWatch.

Always write an incident report and check in with the client within 24 to 48 hours.

RECORD FOR THIS SESSION

Color line · lot	Formula · grams	Developer · ratio	Process time
Level · % gray	**Allergy test · result**	**Strand test · result**	**Next visit · initials**